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EU AI Act

Finland

Country Profile

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Foreword

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In many domains, artificial intelligence (AI) is moving from experimentation to real deployment, reshaping regulation, innovation and public-sector capability. This country profile examines how Finland is preparing for the EU Artificial Intelligence Act, highlighting progress in data governance, high-performance computing and responsible AI adoption across sectors such as health, mobility and the bioeconomy. Key challenges remain: expanding supervisory capacity, clarifying requirements for SMEs, strengthening conformity pathways and ensuring transparency. By investing in skills, coordination and shared standards, Finland can ensure AI supports anticipatory, trustworthy and resilient governance.

AI Without a Name? The Invisible Layer That Challenges the Boundaries of Regulation

Many Finnish organisations already make use of AI-based solutions, for example in recruitment, competence assessment, or employee experience management, without these systems being explicitly recognised as "artificial intelligence." This creates a phenomenon that could be called invisible AI: systems that influence decisions but remain outside documentation, impact assessment, and regulatory frameworks.

This practical grey zone is critical. It is precisely within these systems that risks to transparency, fairness and accountability may arise, especially when they directly affect people and their opportunities.

Organisations are not necessarily acting irresponsibly. More often, the issue is that the AI nature of certain systems is not recognised, or that evaluation practices have not yet been developed. This points to one of the major practical challenges in AI governance: how to guide development in a context where the boundaries of AI are not technical, but cultural.

Turo Manninen

Co-Founder,
HR2Y OY

‘AI Adoption struggles driven by concerns around AI governance’

“Finnish companies and public sector organizations have continued to upskill their management and workforce, especially in generative AI. Companies across many sectors have made major advances in bringing AI capabilities into their products and workflows, including media, journalism, and marketing.

“At the same time, many organizations continue to struggle with AI adoption due to a range of concerns and challenges related to AI governance and AI competencies. While AI capabilities are in some sense more accessible than ever, there are clear differences between frontrunner organizations and those that lag behind.

“One major theme for 2026 is the focus on “AI ROI” – realizing and pursuing substantial, measurable business benefits.”

Paavo Ritala

Professor of Strategy & Innovation,

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Executive Summary

This report examines how Finland is translating the EU Artificial Intelligence Act into national policy and enforcement practice. It highlights Finland's overall readiness, early implementation measures, and sectoral exposure to AI regulation. The overview summarises key institutional developments, major opportunities for innovation, and the central challenges shaping the national AI governance landscape.

- Finland takes a proactive, whole-of-government approach to AI, embedding it in its national digital strategy and aligning closely with EU priorities.
- Strong investments in data access, HPC and applied research have created a solid foundation for innovation, testing and real-world deployment.
- Skills programmes and industry–research partnerships are strengthening capacity across sectors, with SMEs receiving targeted support to adopt AI.
- As the EU AI Act takes effect, Finland is building supervisory capacity and clearer guidance to help businesses comply consistently and confidently.

In 2026, Finland is set to complete the full implementation of the EU AI Act with a focus on establishing robust national frameworks to support compliance and innovation. The government will finalize and enforce second-phase legislation by 2 August, including the operational launch of at least one national regulatory sandbox designed to facilitate supervised testing of AI systems. This sandbox will provide a controlled environment for identifying risks and promoting innovation while ensuring adherence to regulatory requirements. Finland will also implement a high-risk AI register and empower approximately 10 decentralized authorities with supervisory and sanctioning powers, coordinated through Traficom as the national contact point. Throughout the first half of 2026, the AI Act working group will continue its efforts to refine legislative proposals and stakeholder collaboration, aiming to create a governance ecosystem that balances safety, compliance, and technological progress. The potential early introduction of sandbox rules around February will further signal Finland's commitment to facilitating innovation-friendly AI regulation. Finland's strategic approach aligns with EU-wide initiatives such as the October "Apply AI" rollout and the Commission's Digital Omnibus simplification package, positioning the country to actively shape AI governance in line with evolving regulatory standards. This forward-looking framework reflects Finland's intention to maintain a leadership role in the responsible development and deployment of AI within Europe.

EU AI Act Enters Into Force

EU AI Act published and becomes legally effective.

1 August 2024

Entry of AI Regulatory Sandbox

Potential entry into force for sandbox rules, per some regulatory outlooks.

1 February 2026

Second-Stage Implementation

Government proposal for 2nd-sta implementation, inc. sandboxes, with the AI Act working group active until 30 June 2026.

30 June 2026

Rules Apply

Key EU and Finnish AI obligations come into effect.

2 August 2026

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Who Are We

AI That You Can Trust

Why Us?

Stay on the right side of history. At AI & Partners, we believe AI should unlock potential—not cause harm. We've seen the fear and fallout when teams lose control of AI, but also the trust and innovation that follow when it's handled responsibly. That's why we exist: to help you build AI you can trust and stand behind—for the long run.

What Do We Do?

We enable safe AI usage—for your organization and your clients. Unknown AI adoption leads to confusion, risk, and reputational damage. We help you take control with tools to identify, monitor, and govern all AI systems—so you're not reacting to AI, you're leading it.

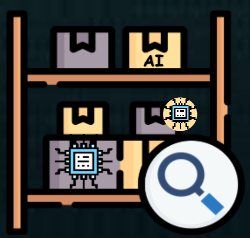
How Do We Do It?

Do you know what AI systems you have? Identify all known and unknown AI systems (algorithms, LLMs, prompts, and models) from all internal and external AI vendors, automated by generating your inventory. Overall, 80% of AI inventory is unknown to our clients.

How do you guarantee ongoing safe AI use? Continuously monitor deployed AI systems for performance drift, anomalies or failures, real-world impacts, and emerging risks (e.g. data poisoning). Any malfunction of an AI system has severe implications for organisations (e.g. inability to assess online misinformation that leads to widespread public mistrust), so monitoring becomes a matter of urgency.

80%

of AI systems are unknown



AI Discovery & AI Inventory

Automatically detect all AI systems, including models, algorithms, and prompts, and maintain a live, always-updated register for full visibility and compliance.

Responsible AI

Embed fairness, transparency, and control into every stage of AI use—aligning with the EU AI Act and building 'Trustworthy-by-Design'.

Model Monitoring

Continuously track your AI models after deployment to detect drift, bias, or failure—so you stay in control and prevent harm before it happens.

Contents

This section provides a structured overview of the report's organisation, guiding readers through the main areas of analysis. It lists each major section and its focus—ranging from strategic and policy developments to regulatory implementation and market readiness.

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National Strategy & Policy Framework

Finland has developed a national approach to AI that aligns closely with the objectives of the EU AI Act. Its strategy emphasises ethical innovation, responsible data use, and economic competitiveness. This section outlines the key pillars of the national AI strategy, how responsibilities are distributed across ministries and agencies, and where national priorities reinforce or expand upon the EU framework.

Finland has taken a deliberately integrated, ecosystem-oriented approach to AI that aligns closely with the objectives of the EU AI Act while also reinforcing national priorities around ethical innovation, data access, computing capacity and skills. Rather than creating a single stand-alone "AI law" at the national level, Finland embeds AI objectives across a suite of digital, research and sectoral policies — most notably the government's **Digital Compass** (the national roadmap to 2030) and earlier AI strategies such as *Age of Artificial Intelligence* and *Artificial Intelligence 4.0*. These instruments set a high-level direction that foregrounds trustworthy, competitive and socially beneficial AI, and they serve as the policy scaffold through which Finland implements and sometimes extends EU-level requirements.

Key pillars of the national strategy

Finland's national approach rests on a small number of mutually reinforcing pillars:

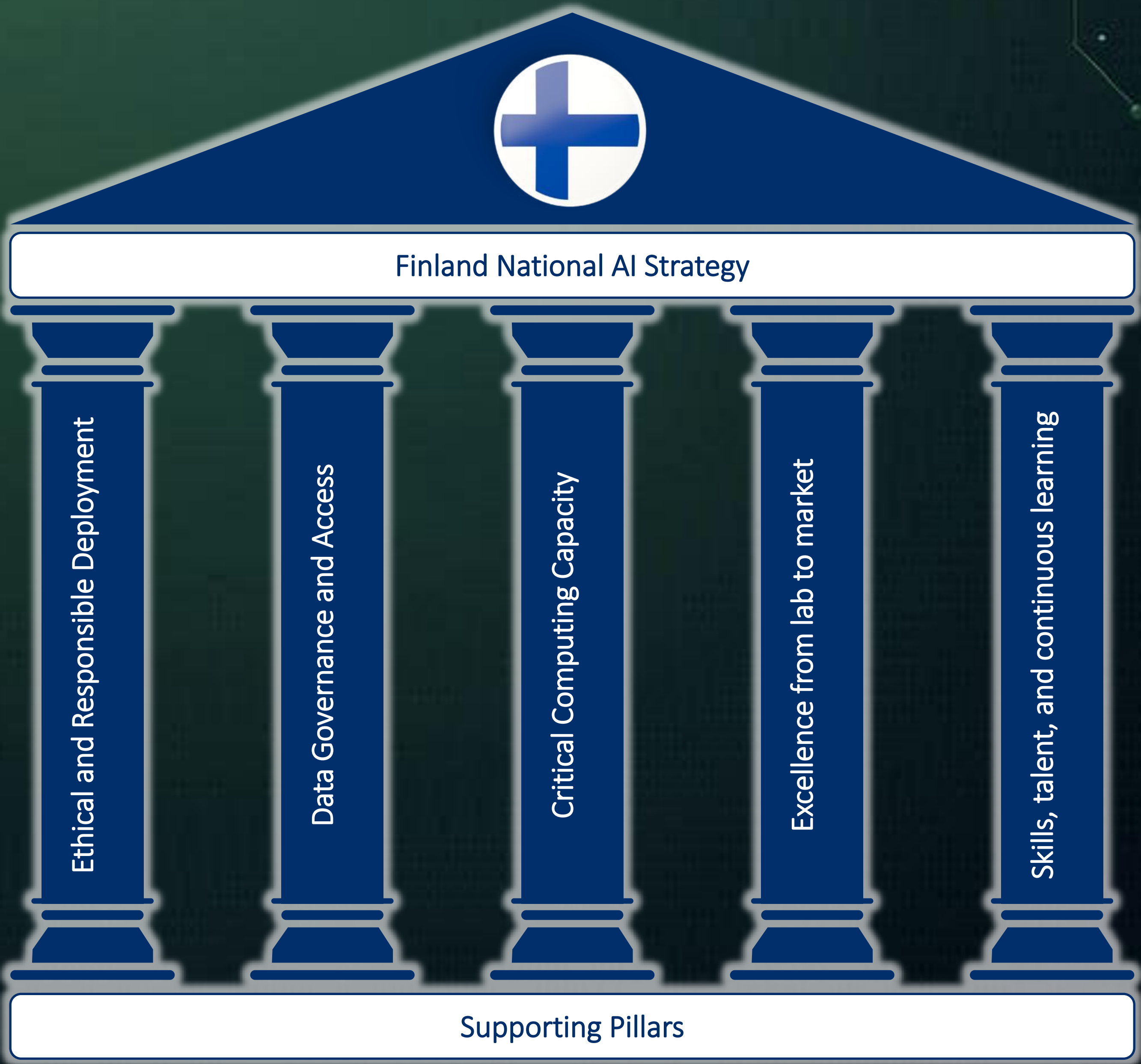
1. Ethical and responsible deployment. Finland emphasises responsible use of AI in public services and business. The Prime Minister's Office has issued government-wide guidelines on the responsible use of generative AI and maintains a cross-government network to share practices and lessons learned; these actions complement the EU AI Act's focus on risk-based obligations and public sector transparency. Finland's approach is therefore to operationalise EU ethical and safety standards through practical guidance and inter-agency learning.

2. Data governance and access. A central objective is to unlock data for innovation while preserving privacy and security. The Digital Compass and Open Government Action Plan frame national efforts on data sharing, transparency and reuse; sectoral initiatives such as Findata (the Finnish social and health data permit authority) are building the institutional plumbing that enables secondary uses of sensitive data — notably in health — under controlled conditions. These targeted national arrangements sit alongside and support EU mechanisms (for example the European Health Data Space) and the obligations of the EU AI Act.

3. Critical computing capacity. Finland explicitly prioritises high-performance computing (HPC) and quantum capability as strategic infrastructure for AI R&D and safe deployment. Hosting the EuroHPC LUMI supercomputer and committing national funding to both LUMI and quantum upscaling demonstrates a policy choice to make world-class compute available for public interest research and innovation projects — a practical complement to the EU's focus on trustworthy development environments and model testing. The government has also updated a "cloud-first" policy to encourage modern, secure cloud solutions across the public sector.

4. Excellence from lab to market. Finland emphasises applied research, testbeds and public-private collaborations to turn research breakthroughs into commercial and public-service value. Flagship research centres (for example the Finnish Center for Artificial Intelligence, FCAI), European Digital Innovation Hubs and regional testbeds such as Tampere City Lab provide real-world environments for experimentation and technology transfer. National innovation instruments (including Business Finland programmes) fund proof-of-concept and scale-up activities, with a particular push on generative AI for SMEs and mid-caps.

5. Skills, talent and continuous learning. Recognising that regulation alone cannot deliver benefits, Finland prioritises education and workforce readiness. The government supports the integration of AI across higher education curricula, funds doctoral training pipelines (including a national Doctoral Program Network in AI) and develops continuous learning services to reskill and upskill the workforce. These measures aim to ensure both capacity to develop safe AI systems and resilience against socio-economic disruptions.



Distribution of responsibilities across ministries and agencies

Finland organises AI policy through a cross-administrative model rather than concentrating authority in a single ministry. A permanent **Coordination Group for Digitalisation** (the Digital Office) and a ministerial working group lead strategic co-ordination; core ministries involved are the Ministry of Economic Affairs and Employment, the Ministry of Transport and Communications, the Ministry of Finance and the Ministry of Education and Culture. This structure supports horizontal policy-making (data, infrastructure, skills and business support) while sectoral ministries lead domain-specific implementation (health, transport, environment, bioeconomy).

Operational responsibilities are divided among specialised agencies and state actors:

- **Business Finland** acts as the principal innovation and trade instrument, running targeted campaigns and funding instruments (including the generative AI campaign and mission programmes) to accelerate commercial adoption and international competitiveness.
- **Research Council of Finland, FCAI and university networks** drive R&D, talent pipelines and research infrastructures that feed into applied innovation.
- **CSC / LUMI and other HPC/quantum projects** provide compute and experimentation resources; national commitments to EuroHPC and quantum upscaling are managed through public research bodies and funding lines.
- **Findata, Kanta services and DigiFinland** administer health and social data access, interoperability and sectoral AI ecosystems (SOTE), reflecting the Ministry of Social Affairs and Health's stewardship of safe secondary uses of health data.
- **Prime Minister's Office and Ministry of Finance** play coordinating and governance roles — issuing guidance, updating cloud policies, and facilitating whole-of-government learning on AI deployment.

This distributed model allows Finland to map EU-level legal obligations (for example, the EU AI Act's risk categories and transparency requirements) into actionable, sectoral responsibilities and to align procurement, data governance and standards work with EU timelines.

Where national priorities reinforce or expand the EU framework

Finland's national strategy generally reinforces the EU AI Act's core aims — safety, human-centredness, accountability and market development — but also extends those aims in three notable ways:

1. **Operational data-infrastructure for sectoral innovation.** By investing in authorities and services (Findata, Kanta) and in national HPC/quantum capacity, Finland moves beyond legal compliance to create the environments where compliant, high-value AI innovation can actually occur — especially in health and public services. This materially supports the EU's objectives around safe data use and innovation ecosystems.

2. **Practical, government-wide guidance and experimentation.** Finland complements top-down rules with bottom-up experimentation (testbeds, city labs) and government guidelines (responsible generative AI) so that public organisations can both comply with and learn from the deployment of frontier systems. This accelerates the translation of EU requirements into procurement, contracts and operational practices.

3. **Targets for skills and market readiness.** Finland pushes talent and business support instruments (doctoral funding, Business Finland missions, Digital Native Finland programmes) that actively aim to capture the economic opportunity from AI while distributing capacity across regions and sectors. This emphasis on workforce and SME readiness is a practical reinforcement of the EU's competitiveness goals.

In sum, Finland's approach is recognisably EU-aligned in legal and ethical terms, but distinct in its emphasis on pragmatic enablers — data authorities, compute infrastructure, testbeds and targeted innovation funding — that turn compliance into capability. The distribution of responsibilities across ministries and specialist agencies is designed to channel EU requirements into sectoral practice, while national programmes push further on compute, data reuse and skills so that Finnish industry and public services can both meet the EU AI Act and seize the economic and societal benefits of trustworthy AI.

Tables 1-3 showcase Finland's initiatives to foster trustworthy AI.

Table 1: Enabling conditions for AI development and uptake in the European Union: Key initiatives

Name	Start year	Short description (main goals)	Funding (including EU funding use)
Digital Compass data policy	2022	Finland's Digital Compass encompasses data policy, e.g. it outlines the country's vision and goals regarding data management, sharing and use.	Not reported
Open Government Action Plan 2023-2027	2023	The action plan supports the development of data policies that align with the principles of open government. It emphasises transparency, accountability and citizen participation in government activities. It includes initiatives to enhance data accessibility and promote the use of open data (OGP, 2024[4]).	Not reported
Central government guidelines on cloud policies	2023 (update)	The Ministry of Finance updated the central government's cloud guidelines on cloud policies in 2023 (Finnish Government, 2023[5]). The updated policies emphasise a "cloud first" strategy, encouraging the use of cloud solutions as the primary option. They also address the handling of public and	Not reported

Name	Start year	Short description (main goals)	Funding (including EU funding use)
		confidential data in cloud environments, ensuring that data protection and security measures are in place. A technical guide (Cirrus project) has likewise been released including practical templates and models to facilitate the procurement, implementation and use of cloud services.	
European High Performance Computing Joint Undertaking (EuroHPC JU) supercomputers	2024	Finland hosts the EuroHPC JU supercomputer LUMI, which is located in the CSC data centre in Kajaani. In March 2024, Finland made a funding commitment of up to EUR 250 million in the context of an upcoming call for new top-level EuroHPC JU supercomputers.	Finland's share of the LUMI budget: approximately EUR 48 million; funding commitment for new EuroHPC JU supercomputer hosting call: up to EUR 250 million
Develop and upscale quantum computer capacity	2023	Further to VTT Technical Research Centre of Finland's announcement that they would continue the development of a quantum computer with a minimum of 50 quantum bits (qubits) for use in Finland by 2025 in its 2023 budget session, the Finnish Government allocated EUR 70 million to VTT for upscaling the	EUR 70 million

Name	Start year	Short description (main goals)	Funding (including EU funding use)
		quantum computer to 300 qubits by 2027. HPC will be leveraged through the development of a national quantum computing environment by linking the quantum computer with LUMI.	
Participation in the LUMI-Q project	2024	Finland is taking part in the EuroHPC JU LUMI-Q project to develop a quantum computer located in Czechia (and linked with LUMI). Procurement was launched in 2024.	Not reported
Kvanttinova piloting environment for microelectronics and quantum technology	2024	Finland will form a research, development and innovation (RDI) environment and business cluster for specialised microelectronics and quantum technology, which will be one of the largest and most significant in the European Union. This will enable the levelling of new products and services to an industrial scale. European Chips Act co-financing in accordance with the Finnish Government Programme will be ensured and Business Finland will implement the chip technology programme.	EUR 79 million (2024-27 budget)

Name	Start year	Short description (main goals)	Funding (including EU funding use)
		Preparations will be made for the establishment of a chip centre in Finland as part of the chip package and national co-funding for it will be ensured.	
Chips from the North Strategy		This Technology Industries of Finland initiative benefits from public sector inputs in different areas, such as funding for RDI, research and developm ent (R&D) infrastructure, talent and education initiatives to attract international investments. The strategy aims to enhance Finland's capabilities in semiconductor technology and ensure a competitive edge in the global market.	Not reported

Table 2: Make the European Union the right place: Excellence from lab to the market: Key initiatives

Name	Start year	Short description (main goals)	Funding (including EU funding use)
Finnish Center for Artificial Intelligence (FCAI)	2019	The FCAI is one of the Research Council of Finland’s flagships. It hosts a community of AI experts in artificial intelligence in Finland, initiated by Aalto University, the University of Helsinki and VTT Technical Research Centre of Finland. The FCAI hosts the European Laboratory for Learning and Intelligent Systems (ELLIS) Unit Helsinki, a node in the pan-European ELLIS network. It is implemented through a large project portfolio. The Research Council of Finland’s FCAI flagship funding is a small share of total funding (about 3% in 2019-20) and is used primarily for hiring new researchers to advance the FCAI’s research agenda.	EUR 250 million (2019-26), from a range of sources in addition to the Research Council of Finland
AI Hub Tampere	2020	AI Hub Tampere is a research centre dedicated to applied AI hosted by Tampere University and funded by public instruments. Backed by a coalition of 25 professors combining multiple disciplines, it explores the diverse socio-technical aspects of AI transformation (Tampere AI, n.d.[6]).	Not reported

Name	Start year	Short description (main goals)	Funding (including EU funding use)
Tampere City Lab	2023	Business Tampere operates several initiatives to support AI testing and experimentation, notably Tampere City Lab (Tampere AI, n.d.[7]), which is part of the EU-wide CitCom.ai initiative and network of testing and experimentation facilities (TEFs) to help bring AI innovations to market responsibly. It provides a combination of virtual and physical testbeds for smart city and AI-powered solutions and supports the development and testing of AI technologies in real-world urban environments.	Not reported
Finnish AI Region (FAIR) European Digital Innovation Hub (EDIH)	2022	This initiative aims to foster collaboration and innovation in AI across various sectors, with a focus on the Helsinki region. It centres on practical applications and aims to create a world-class AI research and innovation hub by pooling expertise and resources and supporting regional development and networking. Moreover, FAIR provides a range of experimentation and testing platforms and offers the opportunity to test products and services in real-world settings thanks to testbed platforms in	Finland's national EDIH co-funding for 2023-26: EUR 3.7 million (up to 30% of costs)

Name	Start year	Short description (main goals)	Funding (including EU funding use)
		Espoo, Helsinki and Vantaa, within the 5G/NextG cellular network technologies. There are three additional Finnish hubs in the EDIH network, all of which can support AI uptake by Finnish firms.	
InnoCities	2021	The state has signed long-term agreements with the InnoCities project on the allocation of RDI funding to strengthen globally competitive ecosystems. InnoCities covers all Finnish university and university consortium cities. Implementation mainly takes place with the financing of sustainable urban development for EU programme period 2021-27. The agreements develop close co-operation networks for innovation activity ecosystems, strengthen competence areas and increase the effectiveness of RDI activities. Research and networks are assembled into larger centres where different actors complement each other's competence. For example, the city of Tampere integrated the AI theme into its ecosystem agreement in 2021.	Not reported

Name	Start year	Short description (main goals)	Funding (including EU funding use)
Business Finland campaign on generative AI	2024	See Box 1 for further details.	No budget for the campaign specified, included in Business Finland's overall budget for funding for companies in the field of AI
AI-programmes in Business Finland's Digital Native Finland mission	2021	The Digital Native Finland mission is an instrument of mission-based innovation policy aimed at accelerating the digital transformation of Finnish firms. The most AI-relevant programmes within this initiative include the 6G Bridge Programme, which provides innovation funding to Finnish companies, including AI start-ups, to develop and commercialise new technologies. The programme encourages collaboration between researchers and businesses to drive advancements in AI and telecommunications. In addition, the Data Economy programme focuses on promoting data-driven business models and innovation. It offers funding and support to start-ups and scale-ups, including AI-focused enterprises, to help them leverage data for business growth.	6G Bridge Programme: EUR 130 million* planned innovation funding budget (2023-26); Data Economy Programme: up to EUR 135 million* (2023-27)

Table 3: Ensure AI technologies work for people: Key initiatives

Name	Start year	Short description (main goals)	Funding (including EU funding use)
Recommendations on AI in education, teaching and training	2024	At the time of writing, the National Agency for Education and the Ministry of Education and Culture were developing a set of recommendations related to AI in education, teaching and training. These aim to improve understanding of AI, promote its responsible and safe use, and help provide all learners with equal opportunities (https://okm.fi/en/project?tunnus=OKM021:00/2024).	Not reported
Re- and upskilling initiatives	2024 and earlier	The Digital Service Package for Continuous Learning was being developed at the time of writing. It seeks to produce a customer-oriented and flexible service package that crosses administrative boundaries and supports individuals in making education and career choices, maintaining and developing their competencies throughout their career, and helping align the demand and supply of labour and education. AI is used in the service bundles' different services. The digital vision for higher education Digivisio 2030 programme will bring existing online digital competence courses into a common digital platform. AI plays an important role in the work of higher education institutions, e.g. development of guidance and counselling services to support studies. RRF funding has been used to develop these two initiatives.	Not reported

Name	Start year	Short description (main goals)	Funding (including EU funding use)
		The Service Centre for Continuous Learning and Employment seeks to bridge the gap between the needs of the labour market and employees' skills. It conducts foresight analysis and procures training related to the use of AI applications for the personnel of SMEs. It also helps develop solutions for how AI skills could be strengthened in academic curricula (https://www.jotpa.fi/en/about-us).	
Attracting and retaining AI-related talent	2024 and earlier	The Ministry of Education and Culture has allocated funding to universities for piloting new practices in doctoral education in 2024-27. This additional funding will be allocated to 1 000 doctoral researchers who will be given a 3-year employment contract to complete their doctoral degree. The Finnish Doctoral Program Network in Artificial Intelligence is among the funding recipients. As part of the national, intersectoral Talent Boost programme* for labour and study-based migration and international talent attraction and retention, Work in Finland at Business Finland carry out operations focused on IT and technology, including AI talent. Work in Finland supports companies' ability to attract and retain international talent, including attraction and retention. This includes AI companies (www.workinfinland.com).	EUR 255 million to universities for piloting new practices in doctoral education (2024-27)

Enforcement Architecture

National supervisory authorities have taken central roles in coordinating the enforcement of the EU AI Act. This section describes the institutional structure that underpins supervision, including designated authorities, enforcement mechanisms, and inter-agency coordination.

Finland has organised enforcement of AI safety and compliance around a distributed, sector-aware supervisory architecture that builds on existing regulators and a cross-government coordination layer. The institutional approach emphasises mapping EU-level obligations into national supervisory roles, using specialised agencies for sectoral oversight and whole-of-government coordination to ensure consistent interpretation and implementation of the EU AI Act's risk-based requirements. This can be framed as an extension of Finland's broader digital governance model — a permanent Digital Office/Coordination Group for Digitalisation, a ministerial working group, and a multi-stakeholder Digital Panel — which together create the governance scaffolding within which supervisory responsibilities are allocated and operationalised.

Designated authorities and the division of supervisory labour

Rather than stand up a single, new regulator, Finland leverages an existing ecosystem of ministries and specialised agencies to carry out supervision under the EU framework. Wehighlights that core ministries in the Digital Office — notably the Ministries of Economic Affairs and Employment, Transport and Communications, Finance, and Education and Culture — provide strategic coordination, while sectoral ministries and agencies take responsibility for domain-specific implementation and oversight. This model means that designated supervisory functions under the EU AI Act will be embedded in authorities that already govern related areas (data, health, transport, consumer safety, financial services), enabling enforcement to be both legally grounded and sector-sensitive.

There are concrete national authorities and digital infrastructure actors that will be central to enforcement activities in their domains. For example, the Finnish Social and Health Data Permit Authority (Findata) and Kanta services are already responsible for permitting and interoperability in health and social data — roles that make them key partners in supervising high-risk health AI systems and in overseeing permitted secondary uses of sensitive data. Similarly, national safety, transport and communications regulators (described in sector tables and initiative listings in the note) are the natural supervisors for AI used in mobility, critical infrastructure and communications sectors.

Enforcement mechanisms: tools, powers and practical pathways

The document shows Finland approaching enforcement through the familiar toolkit of supervisory practice — guidance and standards, procurement and public-sector exemplars, sectoral permit regimes, monitoring and inspections, and sanctions where necessary — but it also emphasises enabling measures that make enforcement practicable (data access regimes, HPC for model testing, testbeds and experimentation sites). In short, Finland couples normative enforcement instruments with the technical and institutional “plumbing” required to assess compliance in practice. Examples in the file include: government guidelines for the responsible use of generative AI (which support interpretation of transparency and governance obligations), the Findata permit framework for controlled health data reuse, and investments in HPC and testbeds that can be used to reproduce and audit model behaviour.

Because enforcement under the EU AI Act will require technical assessments (for example to validate conformity or to test high-risk systems), Finland’s emphasis on compute and test environments — notably LUMI and associated research infrastructures — functions as an enforcement enabler: supervised bodies and competent authorities will be able to draw on national R&D infrastructure to support inspections, testing and investigations. These investments are part of Finland’s broader strategy, implicitly linking them to supervisory capacity rather than treating them solely as innovation policy.

Inter-agency coordination and case handling

It is clear that a central theme of Finland's governance model is cross-administrative coordination. The Digital Office and ministerial working group provide policy direction and platform for shared guidance; this is reinforced by government-wide guidelines (for instance on generative AI) that help harmonise expectations across public actors. In enforcement terms, this structure supports common interpretative stances (e.g., what counts as a high-risk system in a given sector), joint inspections, and information-sharing protocols between supervisory authorities — all of which are essential to coherent national enforcement under a EU-wide regulatory regime.

Operationally, research mechanisms can feed into inter-agency enforcement cooperation: sectoral permit authorities (Findata for health), public procurement rules and cloud guidelines (which influence government deployments and therefore create audit trails), and testbeds where multiple agencies, companies and research institutions co-operate. These instruments make it easier for authorities to detect non-compliance, coordinate remedial action, and, where needed, escalate issues to sanctioning processes.

Guidance, inspections and early compliance activity

Finland's emphasis in the uploaded material is strongly on preparing the administrative ecosystem for enforcement rather than cataloguing completed sanctioning cases. Government-wide guidance (for example the Prime Minister's Office guidance on responsible generative AI) and sectoral initiatives are designed to surface compliance issues early (testbeds, experimentation with AI in legislative drafting, and the SOTE AI ecosystem in health), all of which serve preventative and diagnostic enforcement roles — clarifying expectations and identifying implementation challenges before they escalate into formal enforcement actions.

However, there is limited public detail on formal inspections or concluded enforcement cases specifically tied to AI at the time of writing. The emphasis is on building capacity (legal, technical and organisational), issuing guidance to public bodies, and establishing permit-based oversight in sensitive domains (health), which together create the conditions for future inspections and compliance proceedings. In short: Finland is using guidance, pilot inspections and controlled data permit regimes to operationalise compliance, but there is an absence of public data that chronicles an extensive set of national enforcement cases — reflecting the early stage of EU-level implementation when the report was prepared.

Practical implications and likely evolution

Several practical implications follow for how enforcement will look on the ground in Finland:

- **Sectoral institutions will act as front-line supervisors.** Authorities such as Findata (health), transport regulators, and sectoral safety agencies will interpret and apply AI Act obligations within their domains, supported by central coordination.
- **Guidance and testbeds will precede heavy sanctioning.** The government's focus on guidelines and experimentation suggests a compliance-first approach in the near term, using pilots and targeted inspections to surface problems and refine norms.
- **Technical capacity is being built into the enforcement toolkit.** Investments in HPC, test environments and data permit systems are explicitly positioned to enable reproducible assessments and evidence-based inspections

Table 4: Designated Authorities for Finland

National Competent Authorities	Authorities Protecting Fundamental Rights	Notes
Partial clarity. A draft implementing act from October, 2024, appoints 10 already existing market surveillance authorities. The Finnish Transport and Communications Agency will act as the single point of contact. Unclear what body will be notifying authority.	A list of 8 authorities has been published by the Ministry of Economic Affairs and Employment of Finland. 2 additional authorities for Åland appear in the Commission consolidated list.	The draft implementing act is being processed in parliament

2025

02 February 2025

General provisions (definitions & AI literacy) and prohibitions apply

2025

02 August 2025

Rules for general-purpose AI apply and governance must be in place

2026

02 August 2026

Majority of rules of the AI Act come into force & enforcement starts

2027

02 August 2027

Rules for high-risk AI embedded in regulated products apply

Ecosystem & Market Readiness

The domestic AI ecosystem is adapting rapidly to new compliance expectations. Leading sectors such as climate, health, and mobility are investing in risk management, testing, and certification capabilities. This section profiles major actors—industry, academia, and conformity bodies—and outlines how the government supports innovation and compliance through funding, regulatory sandboxes, and partnerships.

Finland’s domestic AI ecosystem is rapidly adapting to the compliance expectations that come with the EU AI Act. In essence, Finland has a mature, well-resourced innovation base where research organisations, public testbeds, industry consortia and targeted government programmes are aligning their activities to deliver both competitive products and demonstrable compliance. Rather than waiting for a single national “AI regulator” to set the market’s pace, the ecosystem is building technical capacity (HPC, testbeds), practical know-how (EDIHs, hubs, guidance) and finance (national and EU funding calls) to help firms — especially SMEs and public-sector providers — meet new risk-management, transparency and conformity expectations.

Leading sectors and how they’re preparing

Several sectors stand out for active investment in risk management, testing and certification capability:

- **Health and social care.** The SOTE AI ecosystem, Findata (the social and health data permit authority), Kanta services and HealthHub Finland create an environment where health AI developers can access permitted data, interoperability standards and testbeds — a strong foundation for clinical validation, conformity assessment and regulated deployment. Public-private programmes such as FinnGen further underpin data-driven product development. These arrangements make health one of the most advanced domains for early compliance practices.

- **Mobility and transport.** Future Mobility Finland, legislative work on road transport automation, and related testbeds signal active preparation for safety-critical AI systems. The sector is explicitly considering legislative amendments and test environments that will be necessary to demonstrate conformity with safety and transparency obligations.
- **Bioeconomy, agriculture and forestry.** The bioeconomy strategy and forest data projects (digital twins, autonomous drones) show how AI is being embedded in traditional sectors — with pilot projects and R&D funding that can be used to establish testing and evaluation practices appropriate to sectoral risks.
- **ICT and language technologies.** Investment in compute (LUMI) and in projects that created large Finnish-language models illustrate readiness in core AI infrastructure and in sectors where model provenance, evaluation and resource-intensive testing are essential.

Across these sectors, certain initiatives — testbeds, EDIHs and public-private partnerships — are targeted that create controlled environments for reproducible testing, risk assessments and the practical work needed for conformity documentation.

Major actors: industry, academia and conformity enablers

Finland's ecosystem combines complementary actors that together improve market readiness:

- **Industry:** Large technology firms, technology-industry initiatives (including private investment announcements) and a broad SME base are engaging with Business Finland campaigns and R&D calls to adopt generative AI and explore compliant productisation. Business Finland's targeted support and export focus helps firms scale while incorporating risk-management practices.

- **Academia and public research institutes:** FCAI, AI Hub Tampere, VTT, university networks and regional hubs (FAIR EDIH, Tampere City Lab) supply deep technical expertise, validation studies, and training pipelines — essential for demonstrating model robustness and for staffing conformity work. Flagship funding and doctoral programmes are explicitly aimed at sustaining talent and applied research.
- **Conformity-related actors and test infrastructures:** While data highlights testbeds, EDIHs (European Digital Innovation Hubs) and HPC/quantum resources (LUMI, Kvanttinova initiatives) as critical enablers of testing and reproducibility, it does not list a single, named national "conformity body" for AI. Instead, the ecosystem approach indicates that conformity assessment is likely to be operationalised through a mix of: accredited laboratories and testbeds, sectoral regulators (health, transport, safety) acting as competent authorities for high-risk systems, and EDIHs/EDIH-like intermediaries providing practical assessment and certification support to firms. There, infrastructure and institutional partners are positioned as the backbone of conformity readiness rather than centralising the function in a newly created national conformity agency.

Government support: funding, sandboxes and partnerships

Finland's policy toolbox is explicitly designed to support both innovation and compliance:

- **Direct funding and targeted campaigns.** EU and national funding lines (including a EUR 20 million RRF call for testing/experimentation projects, Business Finland generative AI campaigns, and flagship research funding such as the FCAI portfolio) supply capital for SMEs and consortia to build compliant prototypes and perform validation studies. Business Finland's campaigns have been a clear lever for market readiness.
- **Testbeds, EDIHs and regulatory-friendly experimentation.** Tampere

City Lab, FAIR EDIH and similar testbeds offer real-world settings where firms can trial systems under supervised conditions (smart-city, health, mobility). These facilities are critical for producing the empirical evidence and audit trails needed for conformity assessment and regulator engagement.

- **Compute and technical infrastructure.** National commitments to HPC (LUMI) and quantum upscaling give Finnish teams access to the compute resources necessary for rigorous model evaluation, red-teaming and reproducibility work — activities that are increasingly part of conformity dossiers for complex models.
- **Skills and workforce programmes.** Investments in doctoral training, continuous learning services, the Talent Boost programme and the Service Centre for Continuous Learning help create the human capital to perform compliance-oriented tasks (model evaluation, documentation, risk management).
- **Public-sector exemplars and procurement policy.** Updated “cloud-first” guidance and government-wide generative AI guidance establish procurement and operational norms that push suppliers to meet public sector expectations — creating a practical market incentive to demonstrate compliance features.

Market behaviour: testing, certification and early maturity

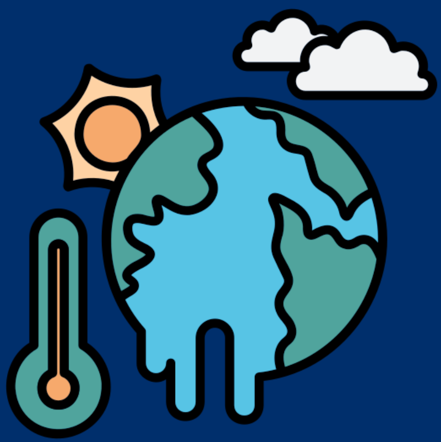
Finnish firms (especially those engaged through Business Finland and EDIH networks) are prioritising testing, pilot deployments in testbeds, and collaboration with research centres to generate the data and audit evidence conformity processes require. SMEs are explicitly targeted by RRF and Business Finland calls to accelerate experimentation and to build export-ready, compliant services. However, the formal, large-scale conformity-assessment markets (third-party certification providers, accredited AI conformity labs) are still emerging — the immediate emphasis is on building reproducible test environments and regulatory interfaces that will sustain a later growth in formal certification activity.

Practical implications and remaining gaps

Finland's ecosystem is well positioned to translate compliance expectations into market practice because of its combination of testbeds, HPC, funding and collaborative hubs. The main shortfall is the relative lack of a single, clearly defined national conformity body for AI — instead, conformity readiness is being distributed across sectoral regulators, EDIHs and accredited test facilities. For market actors this means two near-term priorities: (1) leverage Finnish testbeds and EDIHs to create reproducible evaluation artifacts for conformity dossiers, and (2) engage with sectoral competent authorities early to shape the acceptable conformity pathways for high-risk use cases.

In sum, Finland's market and ecosystem readiness combines strong public investment (funding, HPC, testbeds), an active academic-industrial research base, and practical government instruments (procurement, guidance, EDIHs) that together create the technical and institutional conditions for compliance. It can be said that this is an environment where the emphasis today is on generating the evidence, skills and infrastructure that will make formal conformity assessment and certification both meaningful and scalable as the EU AI Act comes into force.

Table 5: Build strategic leadership in priority sectors: Key initiatives

Name	Start year	Short description (main goals)	Funding (including EU funding use)
Climate and the environment 			
Climate and Environmental Strategy for the ICT Sector*	2021	This strategy outlines measures to reduce the carbon and environmental footprint of the ICT sector, including AI technologies. It includes guidelines for improving energy efficiency and promoting the use of renewable energy sources in ICT infrastructure (Finnish Government, 2021[17]).	Not reported
Green ICT Ecosystem/ Visiiri project	2022	Green ICT Ecosystem (TIEKE, n.d.[18]) is a network that promotes sustainable ICT development and circular economy practices to combat climate change and biodiversity loss. It brings together professionals from academia, public administration, companies and associations to enhance the ecological,	Not reported

Name	Start year	Short description (main goals)	Funding (including EU funding use)
		economic and social sustainability of the ICT industry. The Visiiri project, part of this ecosystem, focuses on assessing the environmental impact of the Finnish ICT sector and supporting the green transition through stakeholder collaboration, impact measurement and training materials. The project is co-financed by the European Regional Development Fund via the ELY Centre of North Ostrobothnia.	
Health 			
AI Ecosystem in Social and Health Services (SOTE)	2024	Established in 2024, SOTE fosters collaboration among public authorities, businesses and researchers to promote AI integration in healthcare (DigiFinland, 2024[13]).	Not reported
HealthHub Finland	2022	This one-stop shop promotes AI applications in the health sector and partner organisation to enable the use of	Not reported

Name	Start year	Short description (main goals)	Funding (including EU funding use)
		Finnish health data for digital innovation (HealthHub Finland EDIH, 2024[19]).	
Second Joint Action Towards the European Health Data Space (TEHDAS2)	2024	The TEHDAS2, co-ordinated in part by the Finnish Innovation Fund, aims to prepare for a co-ordinated implementation of the European Health Data Space and the secondary use of health data (TEHDAS, 2024[12]).	Not reported
Public sector 			
Guidelines for the responsible use of generative AI		The Prime Minister's Office (VNK) has developed common guidelines for the responsible use of generative AI by the government. There is a government-wide network within which experiences and best practices regarding AI use are shared. Furthermore, AI-related co-ordination will be developed within the government under the auspices of the Digital Office	Not reported

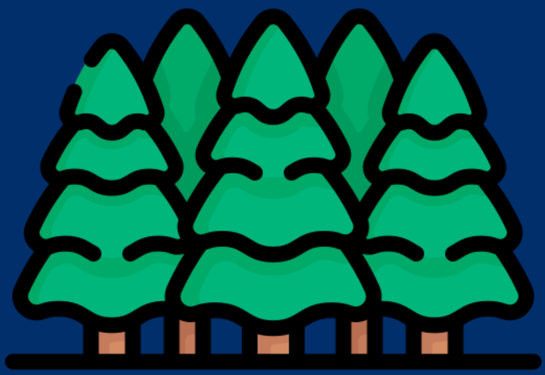
Name	Start year	Short description (main goals)	Funding (including EU funding use)
		co-operation and co-ordination structure. This work builds on experience such as the AuroraAI programme (Ministry of Finance, 2020[20]), which ran from 2020 to 2022 and used AI to streamline public services and improve their accessibility.	
Experimentation with generative AI to support legislative work	2024	The Ministry of Transport and Communications has also experimented with the use of generative AI based on Finnish language models to support legislative preparation (Finnish Government, 2024[21]).	Not reported

Mobility

Name	Start year	Short description (main goals)	Funding (including EU funding use)
Legislative amendments for road transport automation	2024	The Ministry of Transport and Communications has prepared a memorandum assessing legislative amendments required for road transport automation in Finland. It was open for comments until 17 May 2024 (Liikenne- ja	Not reported

Name	Start year	Short description (main goals)	Funding (including EU funding use)
		viestintäministeriö, 2024[22]). Ministry officials will continue legislative drafting based on feedback from the consultation round. The aim is to submit the government proposal to parliament during the 2025 autumn session.	
Future Mobility Finland	2021	Future Mobility Finland (n.d.[23]) is an initiative and communication platform that fosters sustainable and innovative mobility solutions. It promotes the development and use of AI technologies across various modes of transport, including public transport, private vehicles and logistics. It is part of the National Programme for Sustainable Growth in the Transport Sector that ran between 2021 and 2023.	Not reported

Agriculture/forestry/rural development



Forest data collection and management*	2024	Building on the Finnish open forest data system, which was launched in March 2018, new solutions are being developed for forest data collection and management. Many of these solutions involve the use of AI. The most recent projects use accurate forest maps and autonomous drones to help improve the harvesting quality. There are also studies on how gamified mobile applications can be used in the collection of forest data, as well as work on creating digital twins of forests (National Land Survey of Finland, 2024[24]).	EUR 900,000 (2024-26)*
Finnish Bioeconomy Strategy 2022-2035*	2022	The strategy (Finnish Government, 2022[25]) notably promotes the use of AI and other technologies to enhance the efficiency and sustainability of bio-based industries. It supports the development of new bio-based products and services, contributing to Finland's goal of becoming climate neutral by 2035.	Not reported

Key Insights & Recommendations

Overall, Finland demonstrates growing institutional capacity and a proactive stance toward AI regulation. Continued investment in enforcement resources and clearer guidance for businesses will be essential to sustain progress. The report concludes with targeted recommendations to strengthen implementation, support SMEs, and ensure consistent application of the EU AI Act across sectors.

Finland shows a clear, proactive trajectory: institutional capacity, technical infrastructure and targeted funding are already in place to translate EU AI Act obligations into practicable national outcomes. Based on our data we find that Finland combines a strong strategic steer (the Digital Compass and cross-administrative Digital Office), purpose-built data authorities and abundant test and compute capacity to underpin both innovation and compliance.

Several concrete strengths stand out:

- **Strategic coordination and whole-of-government framing.** Finland embeds AI within its broader Digital Compass and operates a permanent Coordination Group for Digitalisation (Digital Office) plus ministerial working groups and a Digital Panel — arrangements that align national AI priorities with sectoral programmes and EU initiatives. This provides a stable governance backbone for consistent interpretation ofEU requirements.
- **High-end technical infrastructure and compute commitments.** Finland hosts the EuroHPC LUMI supercomputer and has committed substantial national funding to HPC and

quantum upscaling — resources that materially enable reproducible testing, red-teaming and technical assessments fundamental to conformity evaluation. These capabilities are a rare national advantage when enforcement requires technical validation.

- **Practical data governance in sensitive domains.** Findata (the Finnish Social and Health Data Permit Authority), the Kanta services and the SOTE AI ecosystem create operational permitting and interoperability arrangements that make controlled secondary use of sensitive health and social data possible — a major enabler for evidence-based assessment of high-risk health AI.
- **A lively innovation-to-market pipeline.** Business Finland's generative AI campaign, RRF and Sustainable Growth Programme calls for testing and experimentation, plus strong public-private partnerships and EDIHs, are actively driving SMEs and mid-caps to build prototypes, pilot in testbeds and pursue export opportunities. These instruments both cultivate market readiness and generate the conformity evidence regulators will need.
- **Testbeds, EDIHs and sectoral labs.** Tampere City Lab, FAIR and other EDIHs provide real-world test environments and intermediary support for conformity work — essential for producing reproducible evaluation artefacts and for bridging firms to competent authorities.

At the same time, there are measurable gaps and risks that must be addressed if Finland is to convert its strengths into timely, consistent AI Act implementation:

- **Distributed conformity capacity but no single national conformity hub.** Conformity assessment readiness is largely distributed across sectoral regulators, testbeds and accredited labs rather than channelled through a clearly identified national conformity body. That leaves potential for inconsistent practices and fragmentation when high-risk designations and conformity pathways crystallise.
- **Enforcement still at a preparatory stage.** Finland has focused on guidance, capacity

building and enabling infrastructure; there are limited public records of formal inspections or sanctioning cases specifically for AI, reflecting the early phase of practical enforcement under the EU regime. This is sensible as a compliance-first stance, but it increases the importance of clear operational protocols and resourced supervising authorities.

- **SME support & clarity needs.** While targeted grants and campaigns exist, small firms face uncertainty about conformity costs, applicable competent authorities, and the documentation/technical testing needed for conformity dossiers. Without tailored guidance and low-cost certification pathways, SMEs risk either non-compliance or being crowded out of procurement opportunities.

Targeted recommendations

Below are pragmatic, evidence-based recommendations — derived from our research — to strengthen implementation, support SMEs, and promote consistent application of the EU AI Act across sectors in Finland.

1. **Publish an authoritative list of designated competent authorities and their remits.** Rapidly publish (and keep updated) the formal list of national competent authorities and which sectors/use-cases each will supervise. This reduces uncertainty for firms and enables regulators to coordinate prior to large-scale enforcement activity. The Digital Office should lead publication and mapping to EU notification processes.
2. **Set up a "one-stop" SME compliance hub and helpdesk.** Establish a centralised, government-backed portal—supported by EDIHs and Business Finland—that provides plain-language guidance, checklists, subsidised conformity templates, and triage to relevant competent authorities and accredited testbeds. This will lower barriers for SMEs to enter public procurement and export markets.
3. **Accelerate accreditation of conformity test labs and build a national conformity marketplace.**

Use public funding to accelerate accreditation of a set of conformity labs and incentivise private sector conformity providers to offer SME-friendly packages (testing + documentation). Publicly endorse trusted EDIHs and testbeds to act as intermediaries for early conformity assessments.

4. **Resource supervisory authorities for technical enforcement.** Ensure sectoral regulators have ring-fenced funding and direct access to national HPC/testbed capacity (LUMI and linked quantum test environments) for inspections and forensic testing. Co-fund secondments between regulators and research institutes to build in-house technical capability.
5. **Publish inspection protocols, thresholds and an enforcement roadmap.** Complement high-level guidance with practical inspection protocols (what triggers an inspection, data and evidence expected, timelines) and a public roadmap showing how pilot inspections will scale — this clarifies the path from guidance to enforcement and helps firms prioritise effort.
6. **Scale easily accessible testing vouchers for SMEs.** Extend existing RRF and Business Finland funding to provide targeted testing vouchers that SMEs can redeem at accredited testbeds/EDIHs for model evaluation, bias audits and robustness testing—lowering the upfront cost of producing conformity evidence.
7. **Embed procurement levers to stimulate compliant supply.** Use central government procurement (cloud-first, generative AI guidance) to require conformity-ready features (transparency logs, documentation, runbooks) from suppliers. Preferential scoring for verified conformity work will create market incentives for certification.
8. **Maintain and publicise an R&I enforcement partnership programme.** Formalise partnerships between regulators, FCAI/VTT/universities and EDIHs to run joint red-teaming, model-replay exercises and pilot inspections. Publicise

findings and anonymised case studies to accelerate sectoral learning.

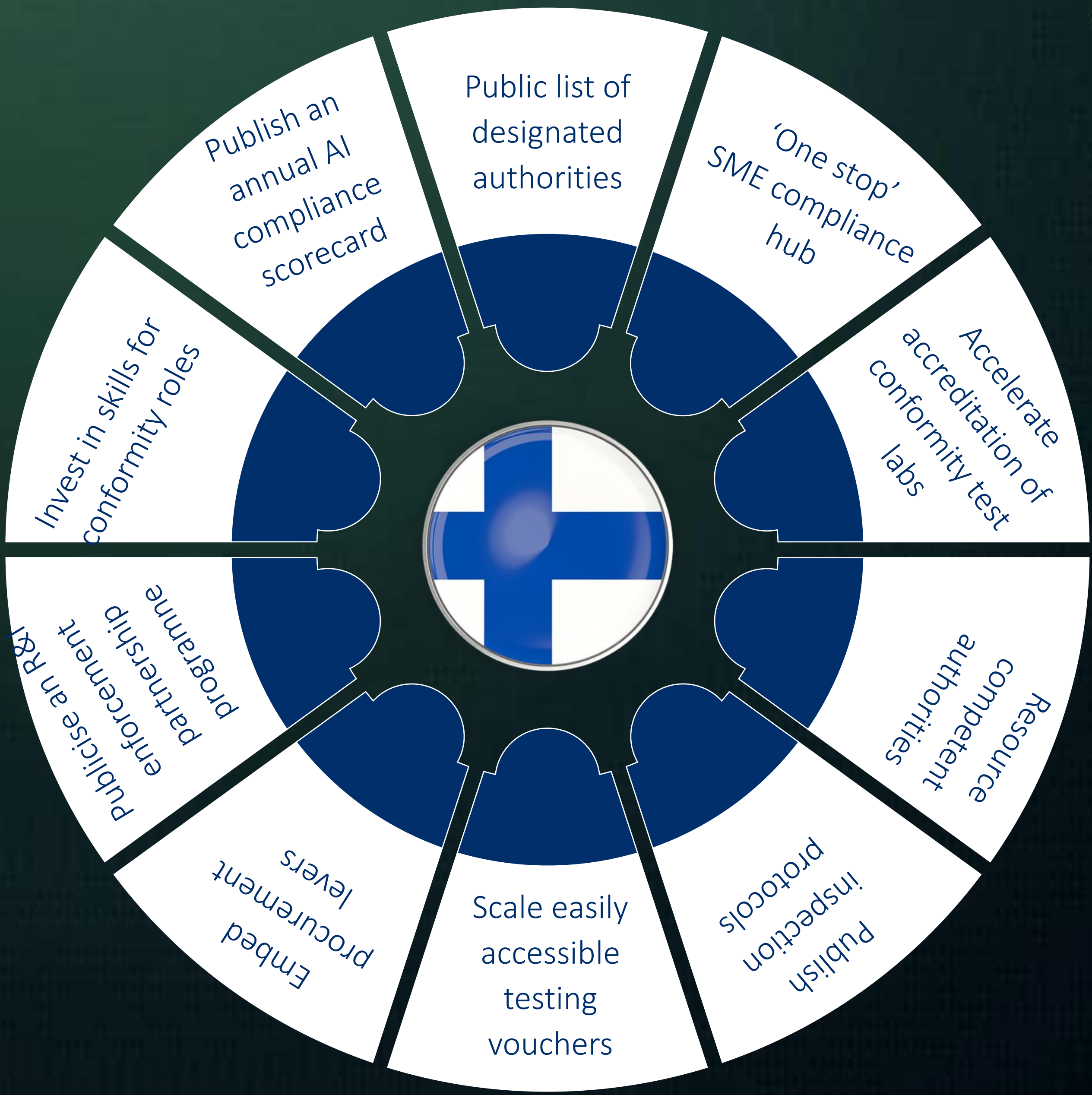
9. **Continue investing in skills for conformity roles.** Fund doctoral and continuous-learning places focused on AI safety engineering, model evaluation, and conformity assessment. Ensure placement pipelines into regulators and conformity labs.

10. **Monitor, evaluate and publish an annual AI compliance scorecard.** Track metrics (number of conformity assessments completed, time to market for certified products, SME uptake, inspection outcomes) and publish an annual scorecard to drive transparency and policy refinement. Use the Digital Office to coordinate metrics collection.

Concluding note

Finland's mix of policy coordination, data permit regimes, testbeds and world-class compute gives it a credible platform to operationalise the EU AI Act in a way that both protects citizens and preserves competitive advantage. The priority now is to translate that capability into predictable, well-resourced enforcement pathways and accessible conformity routes for SMEs. Doing so will maximise both legal compliance and Finland's chance to capture the economic benefits of trustworthy AI.

Figure 1: Targeted recommendations for Finland EU AI Act compliance



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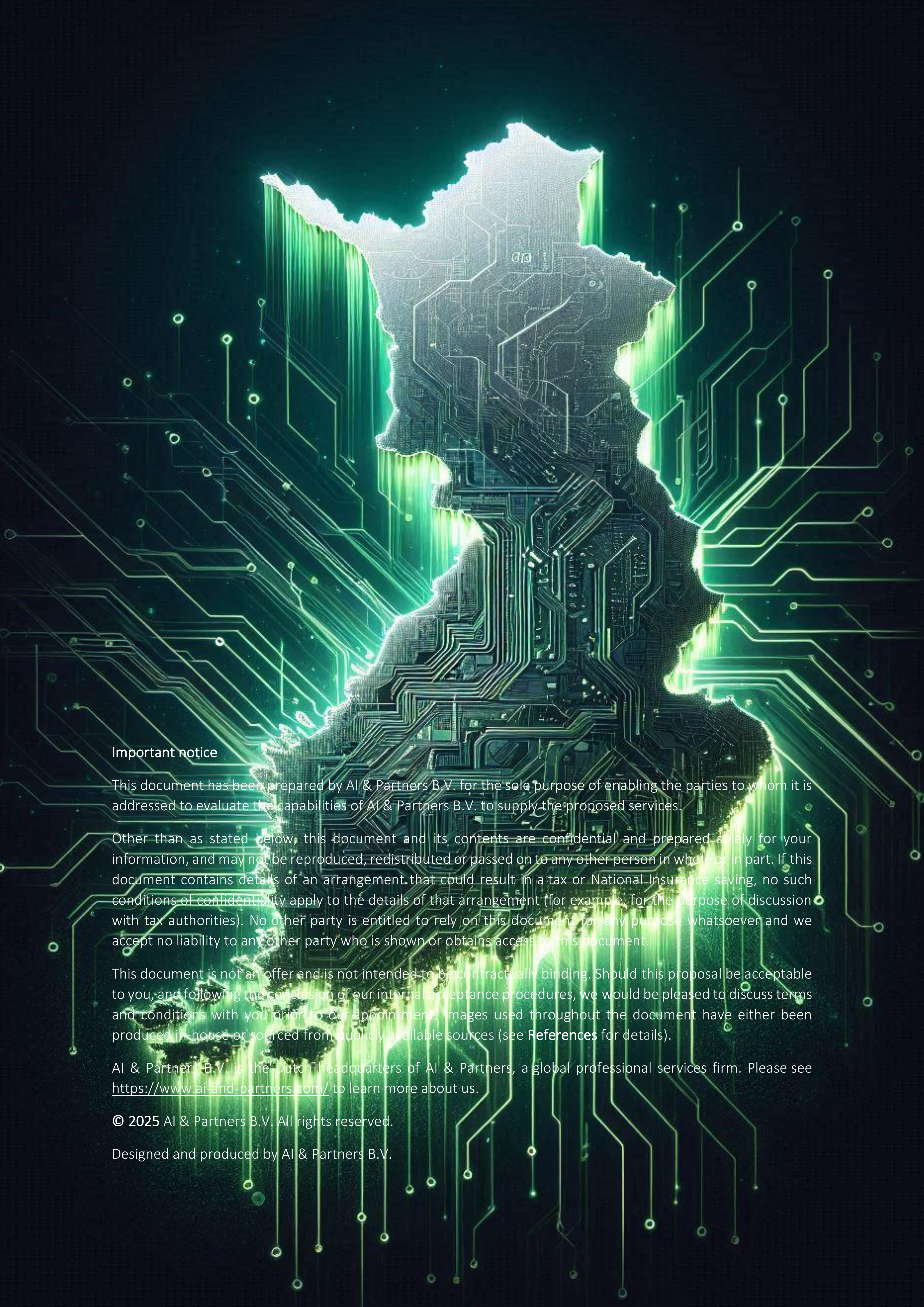

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